

London WW1 & WW2 Memories & Museums



10 Powerful Sites · All Areas · Historical Journey

London was bombed, evacuated, and transformed by two world wars. These 10 sites — from Churchill's bunker to bombed churches — tell the story that school history books can't capture.

YOU SAVE: £187 vs guided tours

■ WHAT THIS GUIDE SAVES YOU

Retail price of this guide
£12.99

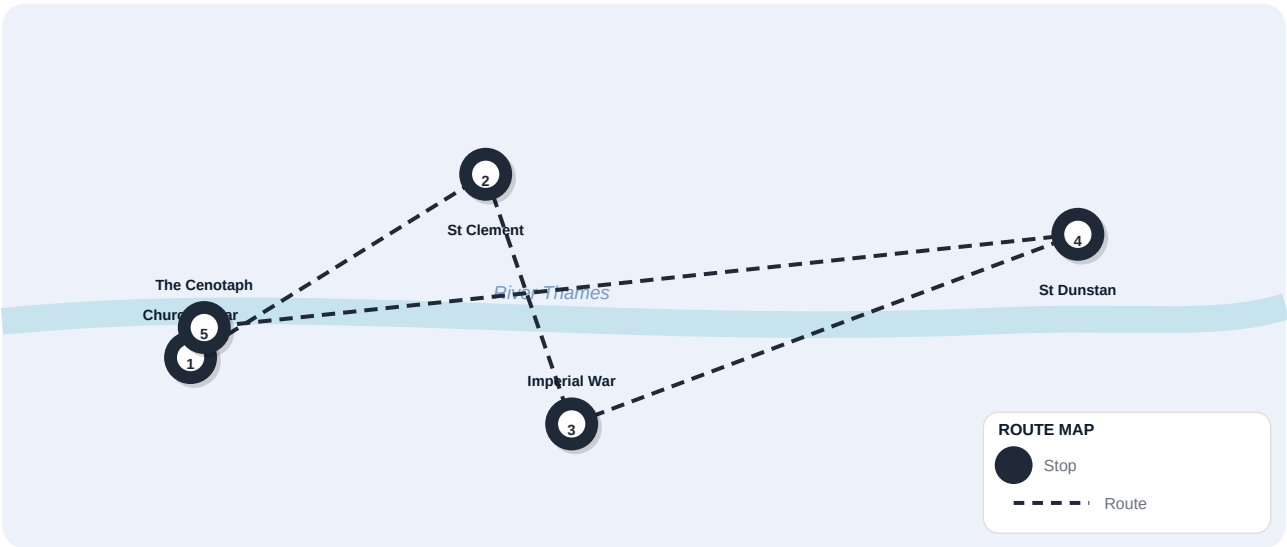
Equivalent guided tours
£200

YOUR SAVING
£187

ROUTE INFO

■ Start	Churchill War Rooms (Westminster)
■ End	The Cenotaph & Horse Guards Parade (Whitehall)
■ Duration	All Areas
■ Transport	From central London: Zone 1–2 daily cap £8.10 covers all stops
■ Total Cost	Guide: £12.99 · Most stops FREE · See individual stop costs

SCHEMATIC ROUTE MAP



PRO TIPS — READ BEFORE YOU GO

■ Best day	Tuesday–Thursday for fewer crowds at almost every location
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■ Saving	Pre-book anything with tickets — usually £2–4 discount per person
■ Offline map	Download Google Maps offline before leaving your hotel
■ Transport	Use Contactless card — automatic daily cap (Zone 1: £8.10, Zone 1-2: £10.10)
■ Members only	This guide is exclusive to London Lens lifetime subscribers

■■ COMPLETE STOP GUIDE — LONDON WW1 & WW2 MEMORIES & MUSEUMS

Follow stops 1→5 in order for the best walking route. Each card includes insider tips, savings info, and the cheapest transport option.

1



Churchill War Rooms

Westminster · Daily 9:30am–6pm

■ START HERE

HIDDEN TIP

The original underground bunker, untouched since August 1945. The last pin placed in the Map Room is still exactly where Churchill's chief of staff left it. Walk Churchill's personal route from his sleeping quarters to the Map Room.

■ SAVING

Book online saves £2 + audio guide included. vs £40 WWII tour: saving £16

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Westminster (5 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Churchill's bedroom — see his actual dispatch box
- ✓ The Map Room (1945 unchanged)
- ✓ Listen to his actual radio broadcast in the original room
- Best: Tuesday–Thursday to avoid weekend crowds

AVOID:

Weekends

★★★★★

£26 IWM

2



St Clement Danes — RAF Church

Strand · Daily 9am–4pm

■ 12 min walk

HIDDEN TIP

The official church of the RAF. The floor is inlaid with the badges of every RAF squadron. During the Blitz it was gutted completely — the rebuilt interior contains the original bells, recovered from the rubble. Ring the bells if you're there at the hour.

■ SAVING

Free entry. WWII walking tours charge £18.
Saving: £18

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Temple (5 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ See the squadron badges in the floor
- ✓ Find the Polish Air Force memorial — often overlooked
- ✓ Attend the free Sunday service — moving and historic
- Best: 11am when the bells ring

AVOID:

Nothing — always peaceful and free

★★★★■

Free

3



Imperial War Museum

Lambeth · Daily 10am–6pm

■ 25 min or tube

HIDDEN TIP

The Holocaust Galleries (permanent, free) are among the most powerful museum experiences in the world. The giant naval guns outside were fired in both World Wars. The WWII gallery on Level 1 covers the Blitz with photographs, objects and survivor testimony.

■ SAVING

Comparable museums in DC charge \$20+. Free here. Saving: £18

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Lambeth North (8 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Holocaust Galleries — free and essential
- ✓ WWII Blitz section — London photographs
- ✓ The original Enigma machine — free to see
- Best: Weekday morning for the Holocaust Galleries when quieter

AVOID:

Going without comfortable shoes — it's a big building

★★★★★

Free

4



St Dunstan in the East — Bombed Church

City of London · Daily dawn to dusk

■ 25 min or tube

HIDDEN TIP

A medieval church bombed in the Blitz, the ruins left standing and converted into a public garden. The walls are draped in ivy, the Gothic windows frame the sky. London's most hauntingly beautiful space — and almost no tourists know it exists.

■ SAVING

A free, unique London experience. Similar 'ruin garden' in Rome costs €8. Saving: £8

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Monument (5 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Sit in the ruined nave for 20 minutes
- ✓ Photograph through the Gothic window arches
- ✓ Find the Wren tower — survived 1666 Fire AND the Blitz
- Best: Spring for the wisteria · Golden hour

AVOID:

Nothing — always peaceful

★★★★★

Free



The Cenotaph & Horse Guards Parade

■ 20 min from IWM

Whitehall · Always accessible

HIDDEN TIP

The national memorial to the war dead, designed by Lutyens in 1920. The inscription 'The Glorious Dead' was Kipling's suggestion. On normal days you can walk up and read the names. Horse Guards Parade behind it was used as a prisoner of war cage in WWII.

■ SAVING

Free. Guided Whitehall tours charge £15.
Saving: £15

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Westminster (5 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Read the full Cenotaph inscription
- ✓ Walk through to Horse Guards Parade
- ✓ Cabinet War Rooms are 3 min away for context
- Best: Early morning when no tourists about — deeply moving

AVOID:

Remembrance Sunday (11 Nov) unless you specifically want the ceremony

★★★★★

Free

QUICK REFERENCE CARD — CUT OUT OR SCREENSHOT

Summary of all stops for easy on-the-go reference.

#	Name	Area	Walk	Cost	Tube	Rating
1	Churchill War Rooms	Westminster	Start here	£26 IWM	Westminster (5 min	★★★★★
2	St Clement Danes — RAF...	Strand	12 min walk	Free	Temple (5 min walk	★★★★■
3	Imperial War Museum	Lambeth	25 min or tube	Free	Lambeth North (8 m	★★★★★
4	St Dunstan in the East...	City of London	25 min or tube	Free	Monument (5 min wa	★★★★★
5	The Cenotaph & Horse G...	Whitehall	20 min from IW	Free	Westminster (5 min	★★★★★

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